

6 29010 003377

THURSDAY

SEPTEMBER 10, 2026
RABI AL AWWAL 28, 1448

TRUSTED NEWS SINCE 1978

gulfnews.com
GULF NEWS



LIVE
UPDATES

The Bridge To Your Home



Cargo, Courier,
Shipping, logistics

800 916
www.abccargo.com

31545865_1421



UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT ARRIVES IN GERMANY

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan is received by Dr Dorte Dinger, Head of the Office of the President of Germany, upon arriving at Brandenburg Airport during a state visit yesterday. The President was accorded an official reception upon arrival, with a ceremony featuring a 21-gun salute and a guard of honour. **SEE ALSO P7, P-11**

Trade through Hatta surges 175% to Dh37.08 billion in H1 2026

Number of loaded trucks climbed 160.1% to 108,811 from 41,831 in H1 2025

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Trade through the Hatta Customs Crossing reached more than Dh37.08 billion in the first half of 2026, up 175 per cent from Dh13.48 billion in the same period last year, according to Dubai Customs.

The increase was accompanied by a rise in overland commercial transport, with the number of loaded trucks climbing 160.1 per cent to 108,811 from 41,831 in the first half of 2025.

More than 919,000 travellers and around 322,000 light vehicles also passed through the crossing during the six-month period, while the number of

transiting buses rose 77.5 per cent.

Trade flows through Hatta

Dubai Customs said the performance reflected higher trade flows through the crossing and operational measures introduced to maintain the movement of goods and supply chains during regional geo-economic shifts.

The Green Corridor initiative, together with other operational and logistics measures, helped attract new trade flows and improve the efficiency of trade movement through Hatta.

Dubai Customs also expanded the base of logistics service providers and attracted new companies to the market, with the aim of increasing competition and providing businesses with more efficient and competitive options amid rising global shipping costs.

“In a world where the map of trade is changing at an un-

precedented pace, the ability to ensure the continuity of supply chains and strengthen investor confidence has become one of the most important pillars of economic competitiveness,” said Abdulla Bin Damithan, Chairman of the Ports, Customs and Free Zone Corporation. “These results reflect the vision of our leadership in building a flexible, ready, and sustainable economy capable of seizing opportunities and turning challenges into growth drivers.”

Smart systems

Hatta Customs Centre used 7,870 electronic seals for trucks under the Shahin system during the first half of 2026. The system protects and tracks shipments without imposing additional fees on customers.

The Customs Inspection Sector at Hatta Crossing also recorded 129 seizures during the period.

SEE ALSO P-1

Dubai’s most popular ride completes 17 iconic years

Dubai Metro carried 294.7m riders in 2025, a 7% rise over 2024

DUBAI
BY ZAINAB HUSAIN
Features Writer

The launch of the Dubai Metro on September 9, 2009 not only transformed how residents move around the city but also how millions of visitors experience it. More than 110,000 people, nearly 10 per cent of Dubai’s population at the time, boarded the Metro within its first 48 hours.

Fast forward 17 years and the Metro has become the backbone of Dubai’s transport system. In 2025, it carried 294.7 million riders across its Red and Green lines, reflecting a seven per cent increase over 2024.

From its launch until 2016, the Dubai Metro held the Guinness World Record as the long-

est driverless metro network, stretching 75 kilometres.

90km, 55 stations

Today, the system covers nearly 90km with 55 stations, split between the Red and Green Lines. With the upcoming Blue Line expansion, Dubai’s total rail network, including the tram, will grow to 131km. The Dubai Metro is the first urban rail system in GCC. Since 2009, it has transported over 2.4 billion riders across more than 4.3 million journeys, boasting an impressive 99.7 per cent punctuality rate.

Dubai Metro has cemented its position as the emirate’s most popular mode of transport, carrying 136.5 million passengers in H1 2026 and accounting for nearly four out of every 10 public transport journeys, as Dubai’s integrated mobility network recorded a total of 348.1 million passenger trips.

SEE ALSO P4

US HITS 4 IRAN TANKERS, SINKS ONE AS WAR WIDENS AT SEA

Tehran targets Jordan, merchant ships under fire

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The US-Iran conflict widened across Gulf waters yesterday as merchant vessels came under fire and Tehran claimed attacks on ships trying to cross the Strait of Hormuz, a day after US forces struck five Iranian oil tankers, sinking one.

Four crude carriers in the Gulf of Oman and another near Kharg Island, Iran’s main oil export hub, were struck on Tuesday, US Central Command said. Video released by the US military showed the M/T Riesco burning and sinking.

CENTCOM said crews were instructed to abandon the vessels before they were attacked.

Washington said the strikes followed two Iranian attempts over two days to hit a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles.

The vessel evaded the missiles and no American personnel were harmed, it said.

Iran retaliated by launching missiles towards Muwaffaq Salti Air Base in Jordan, which is used by US forces. Jordan said its air defences intercepted 18 of 20 ballistic missiles, with two falling in unpopulated areas.

In the line of fire

Yesterday, signs of the confrontation spreading to commercial shipping were mounting. A Panama-flagged tanker carrying fuel oil was struck by an “unknown source” in Iraqi

OIL SURGES PAST \$100 A BARREL

Brent crude surged above \$100 a barrel for the first time since late July yesterday as escalating US-Iran attacks fuelled fears of further disruption to Middle East energy supplies.

The international benchmark jumped nearly 3 per cent to \$100.72, while US crude gained 2.4 per cent to \$95.25.

The oil surge also hit Wall Street, with the Dow falling 0.6 per cent in early trading and the S&P 500 and Nasdaq shedding 0.3 per cent.

— S. N. R.

territorial waters, damaging its hull, Iraq’s transport ministry said.

The United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations said “several merchant vessels” in the northern Gulf and Gulf of Oman had also been subjected to “disabling fire” during ongoing military activity.

One crew member killed

One crew member was killed and another was missing after the oil products tanker Hercules Star was involved in an incident at an anchorage, charterer Peninsula said yesterday. All other crew members were accounted for.

Iran’s Revolutionary Guards claimed they had attacked two

US vessels, eight oil tankers and 10 “non-compliant vessels” attempting to pass through Hormuz.

The US denied Iranian claims that its warships had been hit, saying attempted attacks had failed.

Iran expands restricted zone

In another escalation, the Revolutionary Guards said a new “prohibited zone” would extend beyond Hormuz into parts of the Gulf of Oman and Arabian Sea.

Tehran has demanded that vessels seek permission to cross Hormuz and insists there will be no return to unrestricted pre-war navigation.

Iran has also threatened to target oil tankers off Kuwait and Bahrain.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio warned that every Iranian attempt to attack American naval vessels would bring retaliation.

“Iran continues to try to hit US naval ships and for every time they do that, or try to do that, they’re going to lose tankers,” he said.

The widening confrontation comes as Washington intensifies pressure on Iran by targeting its oil trade, escorting commercial vessels through Hormuz and maintaining a blockade of Iranian ports.

Tehran, meanwhile, says it will not fully reopen the strategic waterway unless Washington meets a series of demands.

— With inputs from AFP
SEE ALSO P10

BUSINESS

UK airports face more disruption following air traffic control glitch | P-1V



IN FOCUS

UAE parents rethink the real purpose of homework | P8-9

MADE IN GERMANY

DIVID&Z

FINISHES
DEFINED BY INTENT

FlexLite & Optiduo

MATTE BLACK

SAPPHIRE

BRUSHED COPPER

GRAPHITE BLACK

BRUSHED ORANGE

TITANIUM GOLD

GLOSSY BLACK

Surface is not decoration; it is elegance made visible at Dividoz

2.68

www.dividoz.com

OFFICIAL STOCKIST AND INSTALLATION PARTNER
TIMBERGLOSS IND LLC, DIP 2, DUBAI, UAE

+971 52 197 5349
sales@timbergloss.com

31545865_1421